

IK 552: Selected Topics in Rāmāyaṇa

Course Code	IK 552
Course Name	Selected Topics in Rāmāyaṇa
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	BTech/MTech/MS/MSc/MA/Ph.D
Mutual Exclusion	None
Approval	42nd Senate (Jan 2024)

Course Contents

- **Understanding the Multiplicity of the Rāmāyaṇa** (10 Hours)
 - The concept of multiple Rāmāyaṇas and their origins
 - Examination of traditional texts with divine origins
 - Exploration of reverential texts developed beyond India
 - Study of texts deviating significantly from Vālmīki's core story
 - Analyzing the popularity and contemporary relevance of traditional Rāmāyaṇas
- **Rāmāyaṇa's Influence on Indian Literature and Arts** (10 Hours)
 - The Rāmāyaṇa as an 'Upajīvyā' or Indian literature
 - Its influence on folk, classical, and contemporary arts
 - The character of Maryāda Purushottam Ram
 - Delving into human and human-nature relationships in the Rāmāyaṇa
- **Characters, Governance, and Society** (10 Hours)
 - Analyzing the portrayal of women: Sītā, Mandodarī, Tārā, Anasūyā, Kaikeyī, Urmilā, Swayamprabhā
 - Unpacking the ideals of 'Rāma Rājya'
 - Role and significance of ṛṣis in society
- **Engaging with Valmiki's Text** (12 Hours)
 - Detailed reading and interpretation of the Vālmīki Rāmāyaṇa text, focusing on Balkāṇḍa, Chapter 1
 - Learning key features and linguistic richness of the original Sanskrit text
 - Group discussions on interpretation and relevance in modern context

Text Books

1. T.R. Krishnacharya & T.R. Vyasacharya, **Srimad Valmiki Rāmāyaṇa of Valmiki** (Critical Edition, with Commentary of Shri Govindaraja) (5 Volumes), Nirnayasagar Press.
2. <https://www.indianculture.gov.in/rarebooks/srimad-valmiki-Rāmāyaṇa-critical-edition-commentary-sri-govindaraja>
3. Baladev Upadhyaya, **Vaidic Sahitya Aur Samskr̥ti** (Hindi), Sharada Niketana, 2001.

References

1. Acharya Lokamani Dahl, **Sanskrita Sahityetihāsah** (Sanskrit), Choukhamba Sanskrit Series, Varanasi, 2005.
2. Raghunathan, N., **Srimad Valmiki Rāmāyaṇa** (English translation), Vighneswara Publishing House, 2001.
3. Goldman, R. P. (Ed.), **The Rāmāyaṇa of Valmiki: An Epic of Ancient India**, Princeton University Press, 2005.
4. Brockington, J., **The Sanskrit Epics**, Brill, 1998.
5. Lutgendorf, P., **The Life of a Text: Performing the Ramcaritmanas of Tulsidas**, University of California Press, 1999.